

Fixing Windows 8

That will be two apps and ₹550 please

Ahmed Shaikh
readersletters@thinkdigit.com

This brief workshop is for those of us who are frustrated with the Windows 8 user interface. Hate the new start menu? Can't stand the 'modern' apps? You have two options: go back to Windows 7, or fix the Windows 8 UI to make it behave like the Windows of old (and good). This workshop will show you how to do the latter.

Let's get started

What will you need? Two apps from the good folks at Stardock: Start8 and ModernMix. The apps are about \$5 each, so you will also need about ₹550 for your Windows fixing. Download Start 8 from www.stardock.com/products/start8 and ModernMix from www.stardock.com/products/ModernMix

The good news is that both apps are available as trial versions. So if you want to give them a spin before spending the \$10, then you feel free to do so! The rest of this workshop will assume that you have bought the apps and have access to all features therein.

What do they do?

The focus of these apps is, well, focused, and singular – Start8 will bring back the

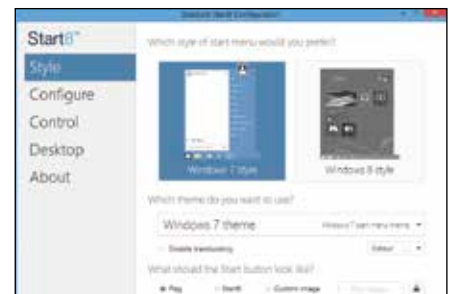
Start Menu that we have come to love, while ModernMix will treat the Modern UI apps more like traditional Windows apps: you can move these around, mix them with non-Modern (medieval?) apps and generally work like you've always worked with Windows.

Using Start8

Once you have downloaded Start8, install it. The setup is very straightforward and at the end of the setup you will come to a configuration wizard that will help you set up the Start Menu to your liking.

Style: This lets you choose the style for the Start Menu. The style dictates the look-and-feel and the options are pretty self-explanatory: Windows 7 style and Windows 8 style. Each style comes with multiple themes, which allow for further fine-tuning of the UI.

Under Windows 7 style: the Default theme will match the Windows 8 UI with sharp edges, the Rounded Theme will round off the corners, the Windows 7 theme will enable a Start Menu exactly like Win7's and so on... note that you can also control transparency for these themes as a separate toggle – very handy if your hardware is not up to the task. Finally, you can also choose a colour to fill the classic Start Menu with: purple, for example.



The configuration screen that shows up when you start Start8



You can fine-tune how the Start Menu looks using these options

